

Statement of Work

Online Therapy & Counselling Marketplace Platform

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This Statement of Work defines the objectives, scope, functional and non-functional requirements, dependencies, and acceptance criteria for the design, build, and delivery of the Therapy Platform. It serves as the contractual reference point between Product, Engineering, QA, and Stakeholders throughout the MVP delivery cycle and beyond.

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1. Executive Summary

The Therapy Platform is an online marketplace connecting clients with verified, licensed therapists through secure video consultation, asynchronous messaging, and integrated wallet-based payments. The platform is differentiated by a comprehensive, real-time AI moderation layer spanning text, image, voice, and video channels, designed to protect users and prevent circumvention of the platform for off-channel communication or payment.

This document defines the complete Statement of Work (SOW) for the platform's MVP delivery and establishes the contract of understanding between Product, Engineering, QA, and Stakeholders. Rather than a flat feature list, each functional module below is documented with its objective, actors, in-scope features, functional and non-functional requirements, API/dependency footprint, acceptance criteria, and explicit out-of-scope items — so that scope, effort, and risk are unambiguous to every stakeholder.

The MVP scope spans sixteen functional modules, from platform authentication through infrastructure and DevOps, plus a dedicated Admin Panel section (Section 5) covering the full operational console used to run the platform day to day. Delivery is targeted within a 26-week engagement window as referenced in Section 14 (Timeline).

2. Project Objectives

- Deliver a secure, scalable therapy marketplace connecting clients and verified therapists.
- Provide a stable, HD video consultation experience with integrated real-time AI moderation.
- Establish a trustworthy booking, scheduling, and payment experience for both sides of the marketplace.
- Build a moderation platform that actively deters and detects attempts to move communication or payment off-platform.
- Provide AI-assisted tools that reduce administrative burden for therapists (e.g., session summaries, SOAP notes) while keeping a licensed professional in the loop.
- Establish a HIPAA-ready, DPDP-aligned architecture from day one to de-risk future compliance certification.
- Provide Admin and Support teams with the operational tooling needed to run the platform at scale.

3. Scope of Work

The Scope of Work comprises sixteen functional modules (Section 4) and a dedicated Admin Panel section (Section 5) covering the full operational console, underpinned by a shared technical architecture (Section 6), external integrations (Section 7), and supported by defined deliverables, milestones, assumptions, risks, and a maintenance plan (Sections 8–16). Each module in Section 4, and each management area within Section 5, should be read as its own contract, with the “Out of Scope” subsection taking precedence over any general statement elsewhere in this document.

#	Module
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4.1	Platform & Authentication
4.2	Therapist Management Module
4.3	Client Module
4.4	Therapist Discovery
4.5	Booking & Scheduling
4.6	Video Consultation Module
4.7	Messaging Module
4.8	Wallet & Payments
4.9	AI Moderation Platform
4.10	AI Assistant
4.11	Notification Module
4.12	Review & Rating Module
4.13	Analytics
4.14	Compliance & Security
4.15	Support Module
4.16	Infrastructure & DevOps

4. Functional Modules

Every module below defines Objective, Actors/User Roles, Scope & Features, Functional Requirements, Non-Functional Requirements, APIs/Dependencies, Acceptance Criteria, and Out of Scope.

4.1 Platform & Authentication

Objective

Provide secure, reliable onboarding and authentication for all platform users across web and mobile, supporting multiple login methods while maintaining strong session and device security.

Actors / User Roles

Client, Therapist, Admin, Support

Scope & Features

Authentication: Email OTP; Phone OTP; Google Login; Apple Login (Mobile); Password Login; Password Reset; Session Management; JWT Authentication; Refresh Tokens; Device Management

User Profile: Personal Information; Profile Picture; Languages; Timezone; Emergency Contact; Preferences

Security: Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA); Device Verification; Login History; Suspicious Login Detection

Functional Requirements

- System shall allow registration via email/phone with OTP verification within 60 seconds of request.
- System shall support social login (Google, Apple) with automatic profile pre-fill.
- System shall issue short-lived JWT access tokens and long-lived refresh tokens.
- System shall allow users to view and revoke active sessions/devices.
- System shall support password reset via secure, time-boxed email/SMS link.
- System shall log every login attempt with timestamp, device, IP and geolocation.

Non-Functional Requirements

- Authentication endpoints shall respond within 500ms under normal load.
- Passwords shall be stored using industry-standard salted hashing (bcrypt/argon2).
- OTP throttling and rate limiting to prevent brute force and abuse.
- 99.9% uptime target for authentication services.

APIs / Dependencies

- SMS/OTP gateway (e.g., Twilio, MSG91)
- Email delivery service (transactional email provider)
- Google OAuth 2.0 / Sign in with Apple
- Internal User Service, Session Service

Acceptance Criteria

- Users can register and verify identity through at least two channels (email, phone).

- Users can log in and remain authenticated across app restarts until token expiry.
- Password reset completes end-to-end without support intervention.
- Logout from all devices immediately invalidates all active refresh tokens.

Out of Scope

- Biometric authentication (Face ID / fingerprint) beyond native OS-level device unlock.
- Enterprise SSO / SAML integrations.
- Passwordless magic-link login (future enhancement).

4.2 Therapist Management Module

Objective

Manage the complete therapist lifecycle from application and credential verification through to active practice, suspension, or offboarding.

Actors / User Roles

Therapist, Admin

Scope & Features

Therapist Registration: Personal Details; Education; Certifications; Experience; License Upload; Government ID; Profile Photo

Verification: Manual Review; AI Assisted Document Verification; Admin Approval; Rejection Workflow; Re-submission

Therapist Profile: Bio; Specializations; Languages; Pricing; Experience; Availability; Session Types

Status Lifecycle: Active; Pending; Suspended; Rejected; In Review

Functional Requirements

- System shall allow therapists to submit onboarding documents (license, government ID, certificates).
- System shall run AI-assisted document verification prior to manual admin review.
- System shall notify therapists of approval, rejection, or re-submission requests with reasons.
- System shall allow admins to change a therapist's status with an auditable reason code.
- System shall prevent booking against a therapist profile that is not in Active status.

Non-Functional Requirements

- Document uploads shall be encrypted at rest and in transit.
- Verification workflow shall support configurable SLA reminders (e.g., 48-hour review target).
- All status transitions shall be captured in an immutable audit trail.

APIs / Dependencies

- AI Document Verification service (OCR + validation)
- File storage / object storage service
- Notification Module

Acceptance Criteria

- A therapist can complete onboarding end-to-end without engineering intervention.
- An admin can verify, approve, or reject a therapist application with reasons captured.
- An approved therapist immediately becomes discoverable and bookable.

Out of Scope

- Automated legal verification of professional licenses with external licensing boards (future integration).
- Continuing education / CE credit tracking.

4.3 Client Module

Objective

Enable clients to manage their end-to-end therapy journey, including session history, goals, and personal preferences.

Actors / User Roles

Client

Scope & Features

Dashboard: Upcoming Sessions; Previous Sessions; Recommendations; Saved Therapists

Profile: Personal Information; Goals; Mental Health Preferences; Language Preferences

History: Session History; Payments; Notes; Prescriptions (if applicable)

Functional Requirements

- System shall display a consolidated dashboard of upcoming and past sessions.
- System shall allow clients to bookmark/save preferred therapists.
- System shall allow clients to set therapy goals and mental health preferences that inform matching.
- System shall maintain a complete, chronological session and payment history per client.

Non-Functional Requirements

- Client health-related data shall be encrypted at rest and access-logged.
- Dashboard shall load within 2 seconds on 4G connections.

APIs / Dependencies

- Booking & Scheduling Module
- Wallet & Payments Module
- Therapist Discovery Module

Acceptance Criteria

- A client can view all upcoming and historical sessions from a single screen.
- A client can update goals/preferences and see them reflected in recommendations.

Out of Scope

- Clinical prescription issuance/e-prescribing workflows (references stored data only).

- Insurance claim submission.
-

4.4 Therapist Discovery

Objective

Allow clients to efficiently find the right therapist through search, filtering, and recommendations.

Actors / User Roles

Client

Scope & Features

Search Filters: Language; Price; Gender; Experience; Availability; Specialization; Rating; Session Mode

Recommendation Engine: Rule Based (MVP); AI Recommendation (Future)

Functional Requirements

- System shall allow multi-criteria filtering combined with free-text search.
- System shall rank results using a configurable rule-based scoring model at MVP.
- System shall paginate results and support sort by rating, price, and availability.

Non-Functional Requirements

- Search queries shall return results in under 300ms at the 95th percentile.
- Filtering shall remain accurate under concurrent therapist availability updates.

APIs / Dependencies

- Search index service (e.g., Elasticsearch/OpenSearch)
- Therapist Management Module
- Booking & Scheduling Module (for live availability)

Acceptance Criteria

- Search returns results under 300ms for the defined dataset size.
- Filters return accurate, deduplicated, and correctly paginated results.

Out of Scope

- AI-based recommendation engine (planned as a future phase beyond MVP).
 - Video-based therapist introduction previews.
-

4.5 Booking & Scheduling

Objective

Provide reliable scheduling and booking capabilities that keep therapist availability, client bookings, and external calendars in sync.

Actors / User Roles

Client, Therapist, Admin

Scope & Features

Therapist Availability: Weekly Schedule; Holidays; Buffer Time; Breaks

Booking: Instant Booking; Request Booking; Reschedule; Cancel; Waiting List

Calendar Sync: Google Calendar; Outlook Calendar; Apple Calendar

Notifications: Reminder; Cancellation; Booking Confirmation

Functional Requirements

- System shall allow therapists to define recurring weekly availability with buffers/breaks.
- System shall support both instant and request-based booking flows.
- System shall two-way sync bookings with connected external calendars.
- System shall automatically manage a waiting list when a preferred slot is unavailable.
- System shall trigger reminder notifications on a configurable schedule (e.g., 24h/1h before).

Non-Functional Requirements

- Booking actions shall be transactional to prevent double-booking under concurrency.
- Calendar sync shall reconcile conflicts within 60 seconds of an external change.

APIs / Dependencies

- Google Calendar API, Microsoft Graph (Outlook), Apple Calendar (CalDAV)
- Notification Module
- Video Consultation Module (session link generation)

Acceptance Criteria

- No double-bookings occur under concurrent booking attempts.
- Reschedule and cancellation update all connected calendars within SLA.
- Clients and therapists receive timely reminder and confirmation notifications.

Out of Scope

- Group/batch session scheduling (multiple clients per slot).
- Dynamic/surge pricing based on demand.

4.6 Video Consultation Module

Objective

Deliver a stable, secure video consultation experience with integrated real-time AI moderation to protect platform integrity.

Actors / User Roles

Client, Therapist, Admin

Scope & Features

Video/Audio: HD Video; Audio; Screen Share; In-call Chat; File Sharing

Connection Resilience: Reconnect; Bandwidth Adaptation; Device Switching

Session Lifecycle: Start Session; End Session; Extend Session; Session Timer

Moderation: AI Content Moderation; Contact Information Detection; Screen OCR; Voice Monitoring; Hand Gesture Detection; QR Detection

Functional Requirements

- System shall establish HD video/audio sessions with adaptive bitrate based on bandwidth.
- System shall allow seamless device switching (e.g., mobile to web) without dropping the call.
- System shall support in-session chat and file sharing scoped to the active session.
- System shall run continuous AI moderation (voice, screen OCR, gesture, QR) throughout the session to detect attempts to move communication off-platform.
- System shall allow session extension subject to therapist/client mutual consent and wallet balance.

Non-Functional Requirements

- Reconnection after a network drop shall complete in under 2 seconds.
- Video/audio streams shall be end-to-end encrypted.
- AI moderation shall run with minimal added latency (<200ms) to avoid degrading call quality.

APIs / Dependencies

- WebRTC/media server (e.g., LiveKit, Agora, or equivalent SFU)
- AI Moderation Platform (voice, image, video pipelines)
- Wallet & Payments Module (session extension billing)

Acceptance Criteria

- Video/audio remains stable across typical network conditions for the target market.
- Reconnection occurs in under 2 seconds after a transient network interruption.
- AI moderation remains active and logging throughout the entire session without gaps.

Out of Scope

- Recording and long-term storage of session video (privacy/compliance decision pending).
- Multi-party (group) video sessions beyond 1:1 consultation.

4.7 Messaging Module

Objective

Provide secure, moderated asynchronous messaging between clients and therapists to support ongoing communication between sessions.

Actors / User Roles

Client, Therapist, Admin

Scope & Features

Core Messaging: Text Chat; Images; Documents; Voice Notes; Typing Indicators; Read Receipts; Message Search

Moderation: Profanity Detection; Contact Info Detection; Spam Detection

Functional Requirements

- System shall support real-time text messaging with delivery and read receipts.
- System shall support media attachments (images, documents, voice notes) with size/type validation.
- System shall run every message through moderation (profanity, contact info, spam) prior to delivery or flag it for review depending on severity.
- System shall provide full-text search across a user's own message history.

Non-Functional Requirements

- Messages shall be delivered within 1 second under normal network conditions.
- All media uploads shall be virus/malware scanned before storage.
- Message content shall be encrypted at rest.

APIs / Dependencies

- Real-time messaging infrastructure (e.g., WebSocket service)
- AI Moderation Platform (text/image pipelines)
- File storage / object storage service

Acceptance Criteria

- Messages and attachments deliver reliably with correct read/typing indicators.
- Moderation correctly flags or blocks policy-violating content per configured thresholds.

Out of Scope

- Group chat / multi-participant threads.
- End-user configurable custom chat themes.

4.8 Wallet & Payments

Objective

Provide a secure financial backbone for client payments, therapist earnings, and platform commission management.

Actors / User Roles

Client, Therapist, Admin

Scope & Features

Wallet: Credits; Refunds; Transactions; Coupons

Payments: Cards; UPI; Net Banking; Refunds; Invoices; GST

Settlement: Therapist Earnings; Commission; Payouts; Reports

Functional Requirements

- System shall support wallet credit top-ups and deduction at time of session booking/consumption.
- System shall support multiple payment methods (cards, UPI, net banking) via a PCI-compliant gateway.

- System shall generate GST-compliant invoices automatically for each transaction.
- System shall calculate platform commission and net therapist earnings per completed session.
- System shall support scheduled payouts to therapists with downloadable settlement reports.
- System shall support coupon/discount code application at checkout.

Non-Functional Requirements

- Payment processing shall be PCI-DSS compliant; no raw card data stored on platform servers.
- All financial transactions shall be idempotent to prevent duplicate charges.
- Settlement calculations shall be auditable and reconcilable against gateway statements.

APIs / Dependencies

- Payment gateway (e.g., Razorpay/Stripe or equivalent, supporting UPI/cards/net banking)
- Invoicing/GST calculation service
- Notification Module (payment/payout confirmations)

Acceptance Criteria

- A client can complete a payment via at least three supported methods without failure.
- Invoices generate automatically and correctly reflect applicable GST.
- Therapist payouts match computed earnings after commission deduction.

Out of Scope

- Multi-currency / cross-border payments.
- Insurance-based billing and claims processing.
- Cryptocurrency payments.

4.9 AI Moderation Platform

Objective

Provide a unified, cross-channel AI moderation system spanning text, image, voice, and video to protect users and enforce platform policy, including preventing off-platform contact sharing.

Actors / User Roles

Admin, System (automated)

Scope & Features

Text Moderation: Profanity; Threats; Self Harm; Contact Information; Spam; PII

Image Moderation: OCR; Phone Detection; Laptop Detection; QR Code; Business Card; Handwritten Notes; Violence; NSFW

Voice Moderation: Speech To Text; Phone Numbers; Emails; URLs; Social Media; Threat Detection

Video Moderation: YOLO Object Detection; OCR; Gesture Detection; Object Detection; Phone Sharing; Laptop Sharing; QR Detection; Screen OCR

Decision Engine: Risk Score; Confidence; Alert; Session Warning; Admin Escalation; Account Restriction; Audit Logs

Functional Requirements

- System shall scan all text, image, voice, and video content flowing through chat and video consultation channels using the appropriate moderation pipeline.
- System shall compute a unified risk score combining signals from all moderation pipelines.
- System shall issue in-session warnings for low/medium risk events and escalate high-risk events to admin review in near real time.
- System shall support configurable thresholds per risk category (e.g., self-harm vs. spam).
- System shall maintain an immutable audit log of every moderation decision and action taken.

Non-Functional Requirements

- Text/image moderation shall complete within 300ms per item at the 95th percentile.
- Voice/video moderation shall run with acceptable near-real-time latency (<1s) during live sessions.
- The moderation model pipeline shall be updatable/retrainable without platform downtime.

APIs / Dependencies

- OCR engine, speech-to-text engine, object detection (YOLO-based) models
- PII/NSFW classification models
- Admin Panel (moderation dashboard) and Notification Module (alerts/escalations)

Acceptance Criteria

- Moderation pipelines correctly detect test cases across all defined categories per pipeline.
- High-risk events generate an admin escalation with full context within defined SLA.
- All moderation actions are logged and retrievable via the audit trail.

Out of Scope

- Fully automated account termination without human admin confirmation for high-severity cases.
- Moderation of content outside the platform's own chat/video/messaging channels.

4.10 AI Assistant

Objective

Provide role-specific AI-assisted tools that support clients in their therapy journey, therapists in clinical documentation, and admins in operational oversight.

Actors / User Roles

Client, Therapist, Admin

Scope & Features

Client-Facing: Mood Analysis; Journal; Exercises; Recommendations; Check-ins; FAQs

Therapist-Facing: Session Summary; SOAP Notes; Progress Summary; Treatment Suggestions; Homework Suggestions

Admin-Facing: Fraud Detection; Platform Insights; Reports

Functional Requirements

- System shall allow clients to log journal entries and receive AI-generated mood trend analysis.
- System shall auto-generate draft session summaries and SOAP notes for therapist review and edit.
- System shall surface treatment/homework suggestions to therapists based on session context.
- System shall provide admins with AI-assisted fraud detection signals across bookings and payments.
- All AI-generated clinical content shall require explicit therapist review/approval before being saved to the client record.

Non-Functional Requirements

- AI-generated drafts shall be produced within 10 seconds of a session ending.
- All AI outputs shall be clearly labeled as AI-generated pending human review.

APIs / Dependencies

- Large language model provider/API for text generation
- Video Consultation Module (session transcript source)
- Client Module, Admin Panel

Acceptance Criteria

- Therapists can review, edit, and approve AI-drafted SOAP notes before they are finalized.
- Clients receive mood insights that reflect their logged journal/check-in data.
- Admins can view AI-flagged fraud signals with supporting evidence.

Out of Scope

- Fully autonomous clinical decision-making without therapist sign-off.
- AI-generated diagnosis or prescription of treatment without licensed professional involvement.

4.11 Notification Module

Objective

Deliver timely, reliable, multi-channel notifications to all platform users.

Actors / User Roles

Client, Therapist, Admin, System (automated)

Scope & Features

Channels: Email; SMS; Push; WhatsApp (Future)

Capabilities: Templates; Scheduling; Retry; Logs

Functional Requirements

- System shall support templated notifications across email, SMS, and push channels.
- System shall allow scheduling of notifications (e.g., booking reminders) ahead of an event.
- System shall automatically retry failed notification deliveries with exponential backoff.

- System shall maintain a searchable delivery log per notification per user.

Non-Functional Requirements

- Notification delivery shall be initiated within 5 seconds of the triggering event.
- Delivery logs shall be retained for a configurable retention period for audit purposes.

APIs / Dependencies

- Email/SMS/push delivery providers
- WhatsApp Business API (future phase)

Acceptance Criteria

- Notifications are delivered reliably across all supported channels with logged status.
- Failed deliveries automatically retry per configured policy and are visible in logs.

Out of Scope

- WhatsApp notification channel at MVP (explicitly marked as a future enhancement).
- In-app notification center with rich interactive actions (future enhancement).

4.12 Review & Rating Module

Objective

Enable clients to provide feedback on therapists while giving therapists and admins appropriate response and moderation capabilities.

Actors / User Roles

Client, Therapist, Admin

Scope & Features

Capabilities: Client Review; Therapist Response; Admin Moderation; Review Analytics

Functional Requirements

- System shall allow clients to submit a rating and written review after a completed session.
- System shall allow therapists to post a single public response to a review.
- System shall allow admins to moderate, hide, or remove reviews that violate platform policy.
- System shall aggregate review analytics (average rating, trend, keyword themes) per therapist.

Non-Functional Requirements

- Reviews shall be moderated (automatically screened) before becoming publicly visible.
- Review submission shall be limited to one review per completed session per client.

APIs / Dependencies

- AI Moderation Platform (text moderation for review content)
- Therapist Discovery Module (rating displayed in search results)

Acceptance Criteria

- Clients can submit one review per completed session; duplicate submissions are prevented.
- Therapists can respond to reviews, and admins can moderate flagged content.

Out of Scope

- Public reviewer profile pages.
 - Third-party review syndication (e.g., publishing reviews to external platforms).
-

4.13 Analytics

Objective

Provide business stakeholders with visibility into platform performance, growth, and operational health.

Actors / User Roles

Admin

Scope & Features

Business Dashboard: Revenue; Retention; Cancellation; No Show; Therapist Utilization; Customer Acquisition; Lifetime Value; Conversion Funnel

Functional Requirements

- System shall provide a configurable dashboard summarizing key business metrics over selectable date ranges.
- System shall calculate cancellation and no-show rates per therapist and platform-wide.
- System shall track the client acquisition-to-first-session conversion funnel.
- System shall support exporting reports (CSV/PDF) for offline analysis.

Non-Functional Requirements

- Dashboards shall reflect data with a maximum latency of 15 minutes (near real-time).
- Report exports for standard date ranges shall complete within 30 seconds.

APIs / Dependencies

- Data warehouse / analytics pipeline
- Booking & Scheduling, Wallet & Payments, Therapist Management modules (as data sources)

Acceptance Criteria

- Admins can view accurate revenue, retention, and utilization metrics on the dashboard.
- Reports can be exported and match underlying transactional data.

Out of Scope

- Predictive/forecasting analytics (future enhancement).
 - Custom self-service BI/report builder for non-technical admins.
-

4.14 Compliance & Security

Objective

Ensure the platform meets applicable data protection and healthcare-adjacent compliance expectations, with a HIPAA-ready architecture and DPDP alignment for the target market.

Actors / User Roles

Admin, All Users (data subjects)

Scope & Features

Capabilities: Encryption; Consent; DPDP Compliance; HIPAA Ready Architecture; Audit Logs; Data Retention; Data Deletion; Access Logs; Role Based Access

Functional Requirements

- System shall obtain and record explicit user consent for data processing and session recording (where applicable) prior to collection.
- System shall support user-initiated data access and deletion requests in line with DPDP requirements.
- System shall enforce role-based access control across all modules handling sensitive data.
- System shall retain data according to a configurable retention policy and support secure deletion on expiry or user request.

Non-Functional Requirements

- All sensitive data (PII, health-related data) shall be encrypted at rest (AES-256) and in transit (TLS 1.2+).
- The architecture shall be designed to be HIPAA-ready, enabling a future compliance certification effort without major re-architecture.
- Access to sensitive data shall be logged with actor, timestamp, and purpose.

APIs / Dependencies

- Encryption/key management service
- Admin Panel (audit log and access log surfacing)

Acceptance Criteria

- Consent is captured and retrievable for every user prior to processing their data.
- A data deletion request results in verifiable removal of personal data within the defined SLA.
- Access logs accurately capture all reads/writes to sensitive data categories.

Out of Scope

- Formal HIPAA certification/audit engagement (architecture will be HIPAA-ready; certification is a separate future engagement).
- Compliance with jurisdictions outside the initially targeted market (e.g., GDPR, HIPAA as a US-specific certification) unless separately scoped.

4.15 Support Module

Objective

Provide clients and therapists with accessible support channels and give the support team the tools to resolve issues efficiently.

Actors / User Roles

Client, Therapist, Support, Admin

Scope & Features

Capabilities: Tickets; Live Chat; FAQ; Knowledge Base; Escalation; Internal Notes

Functional Requirements

- System shall allow users to raise support tickets with category, description, and attachments.
- System shall provide a live chat channel for real-time support during business hours.
- System shall provide a searchable FAQ/knowledge base accessible without logging a ticket.
- System shall support escalation of tickets to specialized support tiers or admins.
- System shall allow support agents to add internal notes not visible to the end user.

Non-Functional Requirements

- First response to a new ticket shall occur within a configurable SLA (e.g., 24 hours).
- Ticket history shall be retained and searchable for reporting purposes.

APIs / Dependencies

- Helpdesk/ticketing backend (in-house or third-party integration)
- Notification Module (ticket status updates)

Acceptance Criteria

- A user can raise a ticket and track its status through to resolution.
- Support agents can escalate and annotate tickets with internal notes.

Out of Scope

- 24/7 live phone support.
- AI-powered auto-resolution of tickets without agent review (future enhancement).

4.16 Infrastructure & DevOps

Objective

Establish a reliable, scalable, and secure infrastructure foundation supporting continuous delivery and platform operations.

Actors / User Roles

Engineering, Admin

Scope & Features

Delivery: CI/CD; Docker; Kubernetes (Post-MVP)

Operations: Monitoring; Logging; Tracing; Backups; Disaster Recovery; Secrets Management; Rate Limiting; CDN; Auto Scaling

Functional Requirements

- System shall support automated CI/CD pipelines for build, test, and deployment.
- System shall containerize all services using Docker for consistent environments.
- System shall provide centralized logging, monitoring, and distributed tracing across services.
- System shall perform automated, regularly scheduled backups with tested restore procedures.
- System shall enforce API rate limiting to protect against abuse and overload.

Non-Functional Requirements

- Target platform uptime of 99.9% excluding scheduled maintenance windows.
- Backups shall be retained per a defined retention policy and restorable within a defined RTO/RPO.
- Secrets (API keys, credentials) shall be stored in a dedicated secrets manager, never in source code.

APIs / Dependencies

- Cloud provider services (compute, storage, networking, CDN)
- Container orchestration platform (Kubernetes, targeted post-MVP)

Acceptance Criteria

- Deployments are automated and repeatable via the CI/CD pipeline without manual server changes.
- A simulated failure/restore exercise demonstrates recovery within the defined RTO/RPO.
- Rate limiting correctly throttles abusive traffic without impacting legitimate users.

Out of Scope

- Kubernetes orchestration at MVP launch (planned as a post-MVP infrastructure upgrade).
- Multi-region active-active deployment (single-region with DR planned at MVP).

5. Admin Panel

The Admin Panel is broken out as its own dedicated section, rather than folded into the generic functional-module list, because it is the operational backbone used to run every other module in this SOW day to day. It is documented here as ten independently permissioned management areas.

Objective

Give platform administrators and support staff a single, secure operational console to manage users, therapists, bookings, payments, moderation, reporting, analytics, platform configuration, audit trails, and controlled feature rollout — without requiring engineering involvement for day-to-day operations.

Actors / User Roles

Admin, Support, Finance/Ops (restricted views)

Access Model

Access to the Admin Panel is governed by Role-Based Access Control (RBAC). Each of the ten management areas below is an independently permissioned module within the panel, so an organization can grant (for example) a Support agent access to User Management and the Moderation Dashboard without exposing Payments or Configuration. All roles and permission grants are themselves managed from within the panel and are fully auditable.

5.1 Management Areas

Each area below defines its own description, capabilities, and functional requirements.

5.1.1 User Management

Central console for managing client and therapist accounts across their full lifecycle, from creation through suspension or deletion.

Capabilities:

- Search and filter users by name, email, phone, status, registration date, and role.
- View a consolidated 360° profile: account details, linked sessions, payments, messages metadata, moderation flags, and support tickets.
- Suspend, reactivate, or permanently deactivate an account with a mandatory reason code.
- Manually trigger password reset, MFA reset, or session/device invalidation for a user.
- Impersonate a user session (read-only, time-boxed, fully logged) for support troubleshooting.
- Bulk actions (e.g., bulk notification, bulk export) on a filtered user segment.
- Manage user consent records and respond to data access/deletion requests (see Compliance).

Functional Requirements:

- System shall allow an authorized admin to locate any user account within 2 search actions.
- System shall require a reason code and free-text justification for any suspension or deletion.
- System shall log every profile view, edit, and lifecycle action against the acting admin's identity.

- Impersonation sessions shall be strictly read-only, clearly bannered in the UI, time-limited (e.g., 15 minutes), and fully recorded in the audit log.

5.1.2 Therapist Management

Operational control surface over the therapist lifecycle defined in the Therapist Management functional module (Section 4.2), giving admins the tools to review applications, verify credentials, and manage status.

Capabilities:

- Queue-based view of pending, in-review, and re-submitted therapist applications.
- Side-by-side document viewer for license, government ID, and certifications with AI-assisted verification results surfaced inline.
- Approve, reject (with reason), or request re-submission directly from the review screen.
- Edit therapist profile fields (bio, specializations, pricing bounds, languages) subject to policy limits.
- Change therapist status (Active, Suspended, Rejected, In Review) with mandatory audit notes.
- View therapist performance snapshot: rating trend, cancellation/no-show rate, utilization.

Functional Requirements:

- System shall present a prioritized review queue ordered by submission/waiting time and SLA risk.
- System shall block a status change to Active until all mandatory documents are verified.
- System shall notify the therapist automatically upon any status change actioned in the panel.

5.1.3 Booking Management

Oversight and intervention tools for the booking and scheduling engine, used to resolve disputes, handle edge cases, and monitor marketplace health.

Capabilities:

- Search bookings by client, therapist, date range, or status (confirmed, completed, cancelled, no-show, disputed).
- View full booking timeline: creation, reschedules, cancellations, session start/end, and any related support ticket.
- Manually reschedule, cancel, or reassign a booking on behalf of a user (with notification to both parties and audit note).
- Issue booking-level overrides such as waiving a cancellation fee or extending a session window.
- Monitor real-time dashboard of in-progress sessions and today's booking volume.

Functional Requirements:

- System shall allow an admin to action a booking dispute (reschedule/cancel/refund flag) from a single screen without switching tools.
- System shall prevent conflicting manual overrides (e.g., double-booking a therapist) with the same validation rules enforced on the client-facing booking flow.
- Every manual booking change shall notify all affected parties via the Notification Module.

5.1.4 Payments

Financial operations console covering client payments, therapist settlements, commission, refunds, and invoicing — the administrative counterpart to the Wallet & Payments module (Section 4.8).

Capabilities:

- View and search all transactions (payments, refunds, payouts) with drill-down to source booking.
- Issue full or partial refunds with a reason code, subject to configurable approval limits.
- Review and release scheduled therapist payouts; hold a payout pending investigation.
- View and adjust commission rules (e.g., per-therapist or tiered commission overrides).
- Generate and re-send GST-compliant invoices and settlement statements.
- Reconcile platform records against payment gateway statements with variance flagging.

Functional Requirements:

- System shall require secondary approval (four-eyes) for refunds or payout adjustments above a configurable threshold.
- System shall flag reconciliation variances between internal ledgers and gateway settlement reports for admin review.
- All financial adjustments shall be immutable once posted; corrections require an offsetting entry, never an in-place edit.

5.1.5 Moderation Dashboard

The admin-facing control center for the AI Moderation Platform (Section 4.9), surfacing flagged and escalated events across text, image, voice, and video channels for human review and action.

Capabilities:

- Real-time feed of moderation events grouped by severity (low, medium, high/critical).
- Drill into an individual event to see the underlying evidence: flagged message/screenshot/transcript excerpt, risk score, and contributing signals from the decision engine.
- Take direct action from the event: dismiss as false positive, issue a session warning, escalate to account restriction, or suspend the account pending investigation.
- View a user's or therapist's full moderation history and cumulative risk profile.
- Configure per-category alert thresholds (e.g., stricter thresholds for self-harm signals than for spam signals).

Functional Requirements:

- System shall surface high/critical severity events to on-duty admins within 60 seconds of the decision engine's escalation.
- System shall require an admin disposition (action taken + note) to close out any escalated event.
- System shall retain full evidentiary context for each moderation event per the platform's data retention policy (Section 4.14).

5.1.6 Reports

On-demand and scheduled reporting across operational, financial, and moderation domains, exportable for stakeholders who do not need live dashboard access.

Capabilities:

- Pre-built report templates: bookings, revenue, therapist utilization, cancellations/no-shows, moderation summary, support ticket volume.
- Custom date-range and filter selection prior to generation.
- Export to CSV/PDF/XLSX; schedule recurring email delivery of a report to named recipients.
- Report generation history with the ability to re-download a previously generated report.

Functional Requirements:

- System shall generate standard reports for common date ranges (7/30/90 days) within 30 seconds.
- System shall support scheduling a report to be generated and emailed on a recurring cadence (daily/weekly/monthly).
- Exported reports shall match the underlying transactional data exactly at time of generation.

5.1.7 Analytics

Interactive, drill-down analytics embedded in the Admin Panel, giving operational and business teams live visibility beyond the static Reports area, aligned with the platform Analytics module (Section 4.13).

Capabilities:

- Configurable dashboards for revenue, retention, conversion funnel, and therapist utilization.
- Cohort and trend views (e.g., client retention by acquisition month).
- Drill-down from an aggregate metric to the contributing individual records.
- Role-scoped dashboards so, for example, a support lead sees ticket/utilization metrics while finance sees revenue/settlement metrics.

Functional Requirements:

- System shall refresh dashboard metrics with a maximum data latency of 15 minutes.
- System shall allow saving and sharing of custom dashboard views between admin users.

5.1.8 Configuration

Centralized, code-free control over platform-wide operational settings, enabling Product and Operations teams to tune the platform without requiring an engineering deployment.

Capabilities:

- Manage commission rates and tiering rules.
- Manage notification templates and channel routing rules.
- Manage session policies (buffer times, extension limits, cancellation windows/fees).
- Manage moderation threshold presets per risk category.
- Manage supported languages, currencies (single-currency at MVP), and coupon/discount rules.

Functional Requirements:

- System shall apply configuration changes to the live platform without requiring a code deployment or service restart.
- System shall version every configuration change and allow rollback to a prior version.

- System shall validate configuration changes against defined constraints before they can be saved (e.g., commission rate within an allowed range).

5.1.9 Audit Logs

A single, searchable, immutable record of every administrative and system-level action taken across the platform, underpinning the Compliance & Security module's audit requirements (Section 4.14).

Capabilities:

- Search audit entries by actor, action type, affected entity, and date range.
- View a full change diff (before/after) for any edit captured in the log.
- Filter to a specific user or therapist to reconstruct a complete history of actions taken on their record (supports investigations and compliance requests).
- Export audit log extracts for compliance or legal review.

Functional Requirements:

- System shall record actor identity, timestamp, action type, affected entity, and before/after state for every mutating action across every Admin Panel area.
- Audit log entries shall be append-only and tamper-evident; no admin role shall be able to edit or delete an existing entry.
- Audit log search shall return results for a bounded query (e.g., single user, 90-day window) within 3 seconds.

5.1.10 Feature Flags

Controlled, progressive rollout mechanism allowing new functionality to be enabled for a subset of users (e.g., internal testers, a percentage rollout, or a specific cohort) before a full platform-wide release.

Capabilities:

- Create, enable/disable, and archive feature flags from the panel.
- Target a flag by user segment, percentage rollout, or explicit allow-list.
- View which flags are currently active in production and their rollout percentage at a glance.
- Kill-switch: instantly disable a flag platform-wide in response to an incident.

Functional Requirements:

- System shall apply a feature flag change within 60 seconds without requiring a redeployment.
- System shall log every flag creation, targeting change, and toggle event with the acting admin.
- System shall support an emergency kill-switch action that takes effect platform-wide within 60 seconds of being triggered.

5.2 Non-Functional Requirements

- The Admin Panel shall enforce MFA for all admin/support logins given the sensitivity of the data and controls it exposes.
- Every one of the ten management areas above shall be independently permissioned under RBAC.
- All administrative actions across every area shall be captured in the Audit Logs area in real time.

- The panel shall be accessible only over authenticated, encrypted connections, with session timeout after a configurable period of inactivity.

5.3 APIs / Dependencies

- All core platform services (User, Therapist, Booking, Wallet & Payments) via scoped, role-aware internal APIs.
- AI Moderation Platform (event feed for the Moderation Dashboard).
- Analytics/data warehouse (for the Reports and Analytics areas).
- Notification Module (for user-facing notices triggered by admin actions).

5.4 Acceptance Criteria

- An admin with the appropriate roles can manage users, therapists, bookings, and payments from within a single console without switching to another tool.
- Every one of the ten management areas enforces its own permission scope; a role without a given permission cannot view or act within that area.
- Configuration and feature-flag changes take effect on the live platform without a new deployment.
- Every administrative action, across all ten areas, is traceable end-to-end in the Audit Logs area.
- High/critical moderation escalations reach the Moderation Dashboard within the defined SLA.

5.5 Out of Scope

- Multi-tenant / white-label configuration management.
- Global platform-wide configuration and tenant management beyond the single-tenant MVP deployment.
- A dedicated mobile app for the Admin Panel (web-only at MVP).

6. Technical Architecture

The platform will be built as a set of independently deployable services behind an API gateway, enabling each functional module in Section 4 to scale and evolve independently.

Client Applications: Web application and native/hybrid mobile applications (iOS, Android).

API Gateway: Single entry point handling authentication, rate limiting, and routing to backend services.

Core Services: Independently deployable services for Auth, Therapist, Client, Booking, Video, Messaging, Wallet/Payments, Notification, Review, Analytics, and Support.

AI Moderation Layer: Dedicated services/pipelines for text, image, voice, and video moderation, feeding a shared decision engine.

AI Assistant Layer: LLM-backed services generating client- and therapist-facing assistive content, gated behind human review workflows.

Data Layer: Relational database(s) for transactional data, object storage for documents/media, a search index for discovery, and a data warehouse for analytics.

Real-Time Infrastructure: WebRTC/media server for video, WebSocket service for chat/presence.

Observability: Centralized logging, monitoring, and distributed tracing across all services.

Security Layer: Encryption at rest/in transit, secrets management, role-based access control, and audit logging spanning all services.

7. Integrations

- Payment gateway supporting cards, UPI, and net banking, with GST-compliant invoicing.
- SMS/OTP and transactional email delivery providers.
- Google / Apple social login providers.
- Google Calendar, Microsoft Outlook (Graph API), and Apple Calendar (CalDAV) for two-way sync.
- WebRTC/media server (SFU) for HD video, screen share, and recording infrastructure.
- Speech-to-text, OCR, and object detection (YOLO-based) models for the AI Moderation Platform.
- Large language model provider for the AI Assistant module.
- Cloud infrastructure provider for compute, storage, CDN, and networking.
- WhatsApp Business API (future phase, not part of MVP).

8. Deliverables

- Fully functional web and mobile applications covering all in-scope modules (Section 4).
- Admin panel covering user, therapist, booking, payment, and moderation management.
- AI Moderation Platform covering text, image, voice, and video pipelines with a decision engine.
- API documentation for all internal and external-facing endpoints.

- Database schema and entity documentation for all core services.
- Deployment pipeline (CI/CD) and infrastructure-as-code artifacts.
- Test plans, test cases, and QA sign-off reports per module.
- User acceptance testing (UAT) support and defect resolution through go-live.
- Operational runbooks covering monitoring, incident response, and disaster recovery.

9. Milestones

Milestone	Indicative Timing	Key Modules
M1 — Foundations	Weeks 1–4	Architecture setup, CI/CD, Authentication, User Profile
M2 — Core Marketplace	Weeks 5–10	Therapist Management, Client Module, Discovery, Booking & Scheduling
M3 — Real-Time Experience	Weeks 11–16	Video Consultation, Messaging, first-pass AI Moderation
M4 — Commerce & Trust	Weeks 17–20	Wallet & Payments, Review & Rating, Notifications
M5 — Intelligence & Ops	Weeks 21–23	AI Assistant, Admin Panel, Analytics, Compliance & Security hardening
M6 — Stabilization & Launch	Weeks 24–26	Support Module, UAT, performance/security testing, go-live

Timing is indicative and subject to confirmation during detailed sprint planning; the overall engagement is scoped at 26 weeks for MVP delivery.

10. Acceptance Criteria (Platform-Level)

Module-level acceptance criteria are defined in Section 4. At the platform level, the following must additionally hold true prior to sign-off:

- All in-scope modules pass QA test cases with no open critical or high-severity defects.
- End-to-end client and therapist journeys (registration → discovery → booking → session → payment → review) complete successfully.
- AI Moderation Platform is active and logging across all live chat and video sessions.
- Security review / penetration test findings rated critical or high are resolved prior to go-live.
- Performance targets defined per module (e.g., search <300ms, reconnect <2s) are verified under load.
- UAT sign-off obtained from designated Product and Stakeholder representatives.

11. Assumptions

- Stakeholders will provide timely feedback and sign-off at each milestone to avoid schedule slippage.

- Third-party services (payment gateway, SMS/email providers, calendar APIs, AI/LLM providers) remain available and within their published SLAs.
- Content, branding, and legal/compliance copy (terms, consent language) will be supplied by the client or approved counsel.
- A single primary deployment region is assumed at MVP; multi-region is out of scope (Section 12).
- Licensed therapist verification remains a manual/AI-assisted internal process; no external licensing board API integration is assumed at MVP.

12. Out of Scope (Platform-Level)

In addition to the module-specific exclusions in Section 4, the following are explicitly out of scope for this engagement:

- Multi-tenant / white-label platform capability and tenant management.
- Formal HIPAA certification and third-party compliance audit (architecture will be HIPAA-ready only).
- Multi-currency and cross-border payment processing.
- Group/multi-party video sessions and group chat.
- Insurance claims processing and e-prescribing workflows.
- Kubernetes-based orchestration and multi-region active-active deployment at MVP.
- AI-based (as opposed to rule-based) therapist recommendation engine.
- WhatsApp notification channel.

13. Risks

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Real-time AI moderation introduces latency in live video/voice	Medium	Run moderation asynchronously where possible; benchmark and optimize inference pipeline.
Therapist verification bottleneck slows marketplace supply growth	Medium	AI-assisted document pre-checks; defined SLA and admin staffing plan.
Payment/compliance requirements (GST, DPDP) evolve during build	Medium	Engage compliance counsel early; design configuration-driven rules where feasible.
Third-party AI/LLM provider limits or cost overruns	Low–Medium	Abstract provider integration; monitor usage/cost; define fallback provider.
Scope creep across a large, multi-module SOW	High	Strict change-control process against this SOW; each module's Out-of-Scope list is binding.

14. Timeline

The engagement is scoped for a 26-week MVP delivery window, structured around the six milestones defined in Section 9. A detailed sprint-level schedule will be maintained separately and updated throughout delivery; this SOW reflects the milestone-level commitment.

15. Commercials

Commercial terms (pricing model, payment milestones, and change-request rate card) are maintained in a separate commercial proposal / master services agreement and are intentionally excluded from this document, which is scoped to define functional and technical work.

16. Maintenance & Support

- A defined warranty/hypercare period following go-live for critical defect resolution.
- Ongoing monitoring, on-call incident response, and scheduled maintenance windows.
- Periodic security patching and dependency updates.
- Quarterly review of AI moderation model performance and threshold tuning.
- Change-request process for any enhancement or scope addition beyond this SOW.